

ENG 101: Academic Writing and Research

Fall 2026 · Second Session (10 weeks) · Mon Oct 5 – Fri Dec 11, 2026 · 3 credit hours

Instructor	Dr. Morgan Ellis
Email	mellis@example.edu
Office	Humanities Hall 207
Office hours	Mondays 1:00–3:00 PM and Thursdays 11:00 AM–12:00 PM, or by appointment
Class meetings	Mon / Wed / Fri 9:35–10:25 AM, Humanities Hall 120
Prerequisite	None.

Course description

A workshop course in reading, writing and research for academic audiences. You will analyze how texts persuade, develop arguable claims, find and evaluate sources, integrate evidence ethically and revise your work through peer feedback. The course culminates in a researched argument and a portfolio that reflects on your growth as a writer.

Learning outcomes

By the end of this course you will be able to:

- Analyze the rhetorical situation of a text: audience, purpose, context and appeals.
- Write a focused, arguable thesis and support it with well-organized evidence.
- Locate, evaluate and responsibly integrate scholarly and popular sources.
- Cite sources correctly in MLA style.
- Revise drafts in response to peer and instructor feedback.

Required materials

- They Say / I Say, 5th edition, by Gerald Graff and Cathy Birkenstein
- Readings posted on the course website
- A notebook for in-class writing

Grading

Component	Weight
Reading responses (6)	15%
Essay 1: Rhetorical analysis	15%
Annotated bibliography	10%
Research essay	25%
Research presentation	10%
Final portfolio and reflection	15%
Participation and peer review	10%
Total	100%

Grading scale: A 90–100 · B 80–89 · C 70–79 · D 60–69 · F below 60. Final grades are not curved; scores are rounded to the nearest whole percent.

Major project

Research essay — a 2,000–2,500 word argument on a question you care about, supported by at least six credible sources (two scholarly). You will build it in stages: proposal conference, annotated bibliography, peer-reviewed draft, final essay and a five-minute presentation.

Course schedule

The schedule may change with notice; changes will be announced in class and on the course website.

Week	Dates	Topics	Due this week
1	Oct 5 – Oct 9	The rhetorical situation; ethos, pathos and logos	—
2	Oct 12 – Oct 16	Reading critically and annotating	Mon Oct 12: Reading response 1
3	Oct 19 – Oct 23	From topic to thesis: making an arguable claim	Mon Oct 19: Reading response 2 Fri Oct 23: Essay 1 draft (peer review)
4	Oct 26 – Oct 30	Paragraphs and evidence; Essay 1 due	Mon Oct 26: Reading response 3 Fri Oct 30: Essay 1: Rhetorical analysis (final)
5	Nov 2 – Nov 6	Finding and evaluating sources	Mon Nov 2: Reading response 4
6	Nov 9 – Nov 13	Integrating sources: quoting, paraphrasing and MLA citation	Mon Nov 9: Reading response 5 Fri Nov 13: Annotated bibliography
7	Nov 16 – Nov 20	Counterarguments and concessions	Mon Nov 16: Reading response 6
8	Nov 23 – Nov 27	Revision and peer review workshop (No class Wed Nov 25 – Fri Nov 27: Thanksgiving break)	Tue Nov 24: Research essay draft (peer review)
9	Nov 30 – Dec 4	Presenting research; research essay due	Fri Dec 4: Research essay (final)
10	Dec 7 – Dec 11	Portfolio and reflection	Mon Dec 7: Research presentations Wed Dec 9: Final portfolio and reflection

Important dates and deadlines

Date	Item	Type	Time
Mon, Oct 12, 2026	Reading response 1	Assignment due	11:59 PM
Mon, Oct 19, 2026	Reading response 2	Assignment due	11:59 PM
Fri, Oct 23, 2026	Essay 1 draft (peer review)	Project milestone	11:59 PM
Mon, Oct 26, 2026	Reading response 3	Assignment due	11:59 PM
Fri, Oct 30, 2026	Essay 1: Rhetorical analysis (final)	Assignment due	11:59 PM
Mon, Nov 2, 2026	Reading response 4	Assignment due	11:59 PM
Mon, Nov 9, 2026	Reading response 5	Assignment due	11:59 PM
Fri, Nov 13, 2026	Annotated bibliography	Assignment due	11:59 PM
Mon, Nov 16, 2026	Reading response 6	Assignment due	11:59 PM
Tue, Nov 24, 2026	Research essay draft (peer review)	Project milestone	11:59 PM
Fri, Dec 4, 2026	Research essay (final)	Assignment due	11:59 PM
Mon, Dec 7, 2026	Research presentations	Assignment due	11:59 PM
Wed, Dec 9, 2026	Final portfolio and reflection	Assignment due	11:59 PM

Course policies

Late work and make-ups. Reading responses are not accepted late, but your lowest one is dropped. Essays lose one third of a letter grade per day late. If you need an extension, ask at least 24 hours before the deadline — reasonable requests are almost always granted.

Academic integrity. All work you submit must be your own. You may discuss ideas with classmates, but written work, code and solutions must be produced individually unless an assignment says otherwise. Using AI tools to generate submitted work is not allowed unless the assignment explicitly permits it; when it is permitted, you must say how you used it. Suspected violations are reported to the Office of Student Conduct.

Accessibility. Students who need accommodations should contact Disability Resources as early as possible and share their accommodation letter with the instructor. All course materials are available in accessible formats on request.

Attendance. Regular attendance is expected and strongly linked to success in this course. If you must miss class, review the posted slides and notes and contact a classmate or the instructor. Absences for illness, religious observance or university-sanctioned events are excused with notice.

Communication. Course announcements are posted on the course website. Email the instructor from your university account and include the course code in the subject line; expect a reply within one business day.

Wellness. Your health matters more than any deadline. If you are struggling, reach out early — the Counseling Center, Academic Success Center and your academic advisor are all free resources.

Getting help

Come to office hours early and often — you do not need a specific question. Free campus resources:

- Academic Success Center — free tutoring and study-skills coaching, drop-in or by appointment
- Writing Center — one-on-one help at any stage of a writing project
- Counseling Center — confidential support for stress, anxiety and other concerns

- Library Research Help — chat, email or in-person help finding and citing sources